PRACTITIONER PROTOCOL

Permanent Wave

Times and rod sizes in [brackets] follow your wave system's instructions and the client's hair. Check your state board rules.

SCREEN

Intake cleared. Never over a hydroxide relaxer. No broken scalp, infection or lice.

STRAND TEST

Required for lightened, damaged, box dye, henna or unknown history. Waiver if declined.

PRE-CARE SENT

No shampoo or scratching the scalp for [24–48] hours. Color [2 weeks] before or after.

SET UP FIRST ☐ Gloves, cape, towels ☐ Rods, end papers, picks ☐ Cotton coil, barrier cream ☐ Applicator bottles, clips ☐ Lotion, neutralizer, lots noted ☐ Ventilation, eyewash, timer

#	STEP	TIME	HOW
1	**Consult & screen**	10 min	Confirm health changes. Note hair history, porosity, texture, density.
2	**Consent & photos**	5 min	Consent signed, relaxer history confirmed. Before photos, even light.
3	**Shampoo**	5 min	Gentle shampoo, no scalp scrubbing. Towel-blot. No conditioner.
4	**Section & wrap**	30–60 min	Rods and pattern per the chart. Even tension, smooth end papers.
5	**Protect**	5 min	Barrier cream on hairline and ears. Cotton coil around the wrap.
6	**Apply lotion**	[ ] min	Alkaline or acid wave per manufacturer. Saturate rods evenly.
7	**Test curl**	[ ] min	Every [ ] min, unwind 1.5 turns at front, crown and nape. Look for a firm S.
8	**Rinse & blot**	[ ] min	Rinse thoroughly with warm water. Towel-blot every rod well.
9	**Neutralize**	[ ] min	Neutralizer on every rod. Process per label, remove rods, rinse.
10	**Finish & aftercare**	10 min	Diffuse or air-dry. After photos. Review sheet and card.

ROD CHART

Rod colors vary by brand: [your color key]

Extra small	Small	Medium	Large	Jumbo
1/8–3/16 in	1/4 in	3/8–1/2 in	5/8–3/4 in	7/8 in +
Tight spiral	Tight curl	Defined curl	Loose curl, wave	Body, root lift
Color: [ ]	Color: [ ]	Color: [ ]	Color: [ ]	Color: [ ]

Patterns: basic, brick lay, spiral, piggyback or croquignole. **Endpoint:** a firm S-pattern that matches the rod size. Check lightened or fragile hair more often, and never go past the manufacturer's maximum time.

IF SOMETHING GOES WRONG

- Solution in the eye: eyewash 15 min, then eye care.
- Hives or wheezing: stop, rinse. Breathing affected: 911.
- Weak curl: reassess in [2 weeks] with a strand test.
- Scalp burning: rinse with cool water 15–20 min.
- Frizzy or mushy curl: rinse, neutralize, never re-perm.
- Breakage at a band: check tension, note on record.

Always write an incident report and check in with the client within 24 to 48 hours.

RECORD FOR THIS SESSION

Wave system · lot	Hair type · porosity	Rods · pattern	Lotion time
Test curl results	**Neutralizer time**	**Strand test · result**	**Next visit · initials**